



AGED CARE DEMENTIA CONFERENCE

Part of

THE AUSTRALIAN
DEMENTIA SUMMIT

Shaping the future of dementia care through
personalised practice, behavioural understanding,
and a culture of safety and trust

2025
11-12 NOVEMBER
Swissôtel Sydney

FEATURED SPEAKERS



Emily Harper

First Assistant Secretary, Market
and Workforce Division – Ageing
and Aged Care Group
Commonwealth Department of
Health and Aged Care



Professor John O'Brien

Head of Old Age Psychiatry Research
Group & Honorary Consultant
University Of Cambridge



Simon Pedzisi

Head of Dementia Care
Opal



Daniel Jameson

Dementia Design Lead
Hammond Care



Kate Swaffer

Former CEO, & Co-founder
Dementia Alliance International



Katherine Platt

Head of Clinical and
Service Governance
Bolton Clark

EVENT OVERVIEW

Dementia is one of the most pressing and complex challenges facing Australia's aged care system. In 2023, over 411,000 Australians were estimated to be living with dementia - a number projected to more than double by 2058. As the second leading cause of death in Australia and the leading cause of death for women, dementia demands focused, informed, and compassionate care.

More than 50% of people in residential aged care have dementia, and the workforce is often underprepared to meet their complex needs.

The Aged Care Dementia Conference is designed for those shaping the future of care: clinical leads, care managers, dementia professionals, and aged care providers who are shaping dementia-inclusive care. This is your opportunity to gain insights, strategies, and knowledge to confidently lead your teams and transform the care experience.

With the new National Dementia Action Plan Framework due for release in mid 2025—alongside the Aged Care Act 2025 in November—now is the time to prepare for system-wide change.

WHAT CHALLENGES WILL WE TACKLE AT THE CONFERENCE?

- **Policy, practice and reform:** Unpack the real-world implications of the National Dementia Action Plan and the Aged Care Act 2025—and how to prepare your team to meet new expectations.
- **Reframing language to empower the care environment:** How do we reframe “challenging behaviours” as unmet needs, and empower our teams to respond with compassion and confidence?
- **Designing Dementia-Friendly Environments:** Discover how thoughtful design can transform aged care settings into safe, comforting, and familiar spaces.
- **Leadership and Person-Centred Care:** Explore how leaders can model and embed individualised dementia care into everyday routines.
- **Technology and Innovation:** Explore how AI, smart tools, and pain detection technologies can enhance personalised dementia care.

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ADVISORY BOARD

Our program is developed in close collaboration with leading dementia care experts who form our advisory board. Their guidance shapes the agenda, identifies key topics and speakers, and ensures the content reflects the evolving realities of dementia care in aged care settings.

In the lead-up to the event, board members contribute critical insights, help frame key discussions, and guide the forum's direction—ensuring it is practical, evidence-informed, and grounded in the lived experience of dementia care delivery.



Simon Pedzisi
Head of Dementia Care
Opal



Sarah Yeates
Chief Executive Officer
Caladenia Dementia Care



Cathy Strachan
Dementia & Palliative Care CNC
Whiddon



REASONS TO ATTEND

- ✓ Learn how the National Dementia Action Plan Framework (mid-2025) and the November Aged Care Act reforms will improve person-centred dementia care and resident protections with



Emily Harper, First Assistant Secretary, Market and Workforce Division – Ageing and Aged Care Group, **Commonwealth Department of Health and Aged Care**

- ✓ Learn best-practice approaches to reduce overmedication and improve dementia-related symptom management, with



Simon Pedzisi, Head of Dementia Care, **Opal**

- ✓ Gain insight into the latest research on Lewy body dementia and explore best practices for diagnosis and management, with



Professor John O'Brien, Head of Old Age Psychiatry Research Group & Honorary Consultant, **University of Cambridge**

- ✓ Perceive challenging behaviour as unmet needs and learn the importance of language reframing to improve care quality, empathy, and team culture in dementia support, with



Jillian Kidd, National Manager – Behavior and Wellbeing Support, **Regis Aged Care**



Jacqueline Wesson, Senior Lecturer Discipline of Occupational Therapy, **Sydney School of Health Sciences Faculty of Medicine & Health**



Esther Westra, Executive Services, **Southern Cross Care**



Jenny Houston, Dementia and Behaviour Support Specialist, **Uniting**

- ✓ Learn practical leadership strategies to empower staff, model best practices, and embed truly individualized care into everyday routines, with



Tanya Critchlow, Executive Manager Nursing and Clinical Governance, **Uniting**

- ✓ Ensure that long-term case spaces feel safe, familiar, and comfortable, like home, with



Daniel Jameson, Dementia Design Lead, **Hammond Care**

- ✓ Learn strategies for leaders and frontline teams to be empowered to reduce harm and build a culture of dignity, safety, and respect, with



Katrina Crump, Clinical Nurse Consultant (Dementia and gerontology), **Uniting**



Katherine Platt, Head of Clinical and Service Governance, **Bolton Clark**



Jodi Havill, Head of Residential Aged Care, **Southern Cross Care**

- ✓ Learn evidence-based strategies to reduce stress, strengthen team resilience, and build a workplace culture where dementia care staff feel truly supported and valued, with



Sarah Yeates, Chief Executive Officer, **Caladenia Dementia Care**



Maree Healey, Chief of People & Culture, **Warrigal**



Nicole Klasen, Executive Director, People & Culture, **Anglican Care**

- ✓ Leverage technology for pain detecting and implement predictive AI into detecting early signs of agitation, appetite loss, and behavioural shifts, with



Nadeem Ahmed, Chief Information Officer, **James Milson Village**

OUR EXPERT SPEAKERS



Emily Harper

First Assistant Secretary,
Market and Workforce Division –
Ageing and Aged Care Group
**Commonwealth Department
of Health and Aged Care**



Professor John O'Brien

Head of Old Age Psychiatry Research
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Katherine Platt

Head of Clinical and Service Governance
Bolton Clark



Dr. Perminder Sachdev

Professor of Neuropsychiatry
UNSW



Dr. Paul Yates

Clinical Associate Professor
University of Melbourne



Jodi Havill

Head of Residential Aged Care
Southern Cross Care



Tanya Critchlow

Executive Manager Nursing
and Clinical Governance
Uniting



Alphine Cena

Head of Residential
St Basil



Jenny Houston

Dementia and Behaviour
Support Specialist
Uniting



Jenny Summerton

Executive General Manager,
Residential Care
Hammond Care



Jillian Kidd

National Manager – Behavior and
Wellbeing Support
Regis Aged Care



Nicole Klasen

Executive Director
**People & Culture,
Anglican Care**

OUR EXPERT SPEAKERS



Esther Westra
Executive Services
Southern Cross Care



Maree Healey
Chief of People & Culture
Warrigal



Sarah Yeates
Chief Executive Officer
Caladenia Dementia Care



Arsh Katoch
General Manager
Transformation & Integration
Hammond Care



Nadeem Ahmed
Chief Information Officer
James Milson Village



Francesca Glamorgan
Senior Dementia Consultant
Montefiore



Katrina Crump
Clinical Nurse Consultant
(Dementia and Gerontology)
Uniting



Cathy Strachan
Dementia & Palliative Care CNC
Whiddon



Jacqueline Wesson
Senior Lecturer Discipline of
Occupational Therapy
Sydney School of Health Sciences
Faculty of Medicine & Health



Amy Sender
Dementia Consultant
Montefiore



Dr Eleni Kavaliotis
Research Fellow in the Sleep,
Cognition, and Mood Laboratory
Monash University



Elisa Baume
Dementia Consultant
Montefiore

MORE TO COME

DAY ONE | TUESDAY, 11 NOVEMBER 2025

- 7:45** Registration
- 8:45** Welcome to Country
- 9:00** Chairperson's Opening Address

NAVIGATING DEMENTIA: FROM NATIONAL POLICY TO DAILY PRACTICE

- 9:10 Government Keynote: Embedding dementia-inclusive policy in aged care**
- Learn how the government's new National Dementia Action Plan aims to improve early diagnosis, enhance care quality, and strengthen workforce training across residential aged care
 - How will the National Dementia Action Plan (mid-2025) and the November Aged Care Act reforms improve person-centred dementia care and resident protections?
- Emily Harper**, First Assistant Secretary, Market and Workforce Division – Ageing and Aged Care Group, **Commonwealth Department of Health and Aged Care**
- 10:00 Polypharmacy: Symptom or system failure?**
- Are we truly treating the person - or simply managing behaviours through medication? What are the risks of high polypharmacy for people with cognitive decline?
 - Learn best-practice approaches to reduce overmedication and improve dementia-related symptom management
- Simon Pedzisi**, Head of Dementia Care, **Opal**
- 10:30** Morning Tea & Coffee
- 11:00** Interactive Round Tables

UNDERSTANDING DEMENTIA: INSIGHTS INTO THE COMMON SUBTYPES

- 12:00 International keynote: Lewy body dementia - an update on our understanding**
- Gain insight into the latest research on Lewy body dementia, including its distinct clinical features and how it differs from other neurodegenerative conditions
 - Explore best practices for diagnosis and management, focusing on improving quality of life through tailored care approaches
- Professor John O'Brien**, Head of Old Age Psychiatry Research Group & Honorary Consultant, **University of Cambridge**
- 12:30 Alzheimer's Disease: Unpacking the progression to improve daily care**
- Explore the typical stages and symptoms of Alzheimer's disease and how they manifest in residential aged care
 - Learn care adaptations that respond to cognitive decline, memory loss, and personality changes – while encouraging autonomy and emotional connection
- Dr. Paul Yates**, Clinical Associate Professor, **University of Melbourne**
- 1:00** Lunch
- 2:00 Vascular dementia: Recognising patterns, planning proactively**
- Understand how strokes and cardiovascular health contribute to vascular dementia – and how its progression differs from Alzheimer's
 - Discuss practical care strategies for managing fluctuating cognition, emotional lability, and mobility-related challenges
- Dr. Perminder Sachdev**, Professor of Neuropsychiatry, **UNSW**

THE MESSAGE BEHIND THE BEHAVIOUR: SYMPTOM MANAGEMENT IN DEMENTIA

- 2:30 Beyond words: Understanding behaviour as a way of communication**
- As residents with dementia lose verbal abilities, their unmet needs (ex.; pain or discomfort) are often expressed through behaviour. Without adequate education, staff may misinterpret these signs, leading to distress for both residents and teams
 - Learn why understanding neurological changes is critical to anticipate needs, reduce stigma, and deliver truly person-centred, compassionate care
- Cathy Strachan**, Dementia & Palliative Care CNC, **Whiddon**
- 3:20** Afternoon Tea
- 3:50 Navigating mood and mental health in dementia: From apathy to agitation**
- Anxiety, apathy, and depression are common in residents with dementia but often go unrecognised or untreated. How can staff better detect underlying mental health issues and behavioural shifts?
 - Learn proactive strategies to manage mood changes through engagement and therapeutic support
- 4:10 Restless nights, restless care: Rethinking sleep in dementia care**
- Sleep disturbances in residents with dementia can lead to increased distress, and behavioural symptoms, while affecting the entire unit. How can better design, routines, and staff awareness support restful nights?
 - Learn best practices of personalised sleep routines, pain management, adjusting temperature and lighting, and calming techniques to improve sleep quality, reduce night-time incidents, create a better care environment
- Dr Eleni Kavaliotis**, Research Fellow in the Sleep, Cognition, and Mood Laboratory, **Monash University**
- 4:40 Panel: Aggression or anxiety? The language that builds cultures**
- Language shapes perception, which influences behaviors, which then become the culture, reflecting the importance of the words the workforce uses on a daily basis
 - What if so-called "challenging behaviours" are simply expressions of unmet needs?
 - Learn how language reframing can improve empathy, care quality, and team culture in dementia support
- Jillian Kidd**, National Manager – Behavior and Wellbeing Support, **Regis Aged Care**
Jacqueline Wesson, Senior Lecturer Discipline of Occupational Therapy, **Sydney School of Health Sciences Faculty of Medicine & Health**
Esther Westra, Executive Services, **Southern Cross Care**
Jenny Houston, Dementia and Behaviour Support Specialist, **Uniting**
- 5:20** Chairperson's closing remarks
- 5:25** Networking Drinks

DAY TWO | WEDNESDAY, 12 NOVEMBER 2025

8:20 Registration

9:00 Chairperson's Opening Address

HOW DEMENTIA CARE SYSTEMS ARE CHANGING

9:10 **Keynote: Improving co-design to improve systems change**

- Explore how international dementia activism and the disability rights movement have the potential to reshape aged care and dementia care through co-design and shared leadership
- Learn what it takes to move beyond tokenism and embed the voices of people with dementia in systems-level decision-making

Kate Swaffer, Former CEO, & Co-founder, **Dementia Alliance International**

10:30 Morning Tea & Coffee

11:00 **Case study: Building DementiaReady: The journey, the impact, the lessons**

- Discover how Montefiore developed DementiaReady - a practical, post-diagnostic support service for people living with dementia at home
- Gain practical insights into implementing evidence-based post-diagnostic support models in your own setting - from clinical governance to frontline care

Amy Sender, Dementia consultant, **Montefiore**

Francesca Glamorgan, Senior Dementia Consultant, **Montefiore**

Elisa Baume, Dementia consultant, **Montefiore**

11:30 **Dignity at the table: Empowering residents through inclusive mealtime practices**

- For many residents with dementia, mealtimes become moments of confusion, or even distress - due to vision changes, difficulty swallowing, or lack of assistance. But what if dining became a moment of social connection, autonomy, and dignity?
- Explore how communal dining strategies, from assisted eating, finger foods, and sensory-aware table settings, can improve nutrition, wellbeing and quality of life

EMPOWERED TEAMS, BETTER CARE

12:00 **Leading by example: Individualised dementia care starts at the top**

- How can leaders in dementia care foster a culture that truly sees and supports each resident as an individual? What does it mean to lead by example in environments where tailored, person-centred care should be the norm?
- Learn practical leadership strategies to empower staff, model best practices, and embed truly individualized care into everyday routines

Tanya Critchlow, Executive Manager Nursing and Clinical Governance, **Uniting**

12:30 **Ensuring long-term care spaces feel like home**

- What if the biggest barrier to quality care isn't the diagnosis - but the environment we place people in?
- Design deeply impacts the emotional wellbeing of residents with dementia. How can we create spaces that feel safe, familiar, and comfortable, rather than overwhelming or clinical?

Daniel Jameson, Dementia Design Lead, **Hammond Care**

1:00 Lunch

2:00 **Panel: Preventing elder abuse: Building cultures of safety and empathy**

- With 39.2% of residents in Australian aged care experiencing abuse from paid staff (Royal Commission), how can leaders and frontline teams be empowered to reduce harm and build a culture of dignity, safety, and respect?
- Discover how empowering leaders to model empathy and equip frontline teams with behavioural insight can significantly reduce harm and foster a culture of dignity, safety, and respect in dementia care

Katrina Crump, Clinical Nurse Consultant (Dementia and gerontology), **Uniting**

Katherine Platt, Head of Clinical and Service Governance, **Bolton Clark**

Jodi Haviil, Head of Residential Aged Care, **Southern Cross Care**

Deborah Karam, Chief Residential Officer, **Catholic Healthcare**

Alphine Cena, Head of Residential, **St Basil**

2:40 **Panel: Beyond burnout: Fixing the system, not the staff**

- Burnout among aged care staff isn't a personal failure - it's a symptom of deeper systemic issues. Are we asking too much of staff without giving them the tools or support they need?
- Learn evidence-based strategies to reduce stress, strengthen team resilience, and build a workplace culture where dementia care staff feel truly supported and valued

Moderator: **Sarah Yeates**, Chief Executive Officer, **Caladenia Dementia Care**

Maree Healey, Chief of People & Culture, **Warrigal**

Nicole Klasen, Executive Director, People & Culture, **Anglican Care**

Jenny Summerton, Executive General Manager, Residential Care, **Hammond Care**

ENHANCING SAFETY AND CARE THROUGH INNOVATION

3:20 **Balancing safety and dignity: Rethinking admission pathways and restrictive practices**

- Are we ensuring safe and appropriate placements or relying too heavily on restrictive environments due to rushed admissions and lack of pre-assessment?
- Learn practical approaches to ensure the environment suits residents' cognitive and mobility needs while upholding rights and minimising restrictive practices

Arsh Katoch, General Manager Transformation & Integration, **Residential Care, Hammond Care**

3:50 Afternoon Tea

4:20 **Leveraging technology for pain detection and personalized care**

- With communication barriers in advanced dementia, how can tech-driven tools enhance care delivery and reduce distress?
- Explore how technologies use facial recognition and smart prompts to detect pain in non-verbal residents and understand how predictive AI can detect early sign of agitation, appetite loss, and behavioural shifts

Nadeem Ahmed, Chief Information Officer, **James Milson Village**

4:50 Chairperson's closing remarks

4:55 Closing of Conference

THE AUSTRALIAN DEMENTIA SUMMIT

Two Conferences. One Strategic Platform.

The Australia Dementia Summit brings together the full spectrum of dementia care through two concurrent, highly focused conferences: the Clinical Dementia Conference and the Aged Care Dementia Conference. Each stream addresses the distinct challenges and opportunities within its domain—equipping professionals with the latest in diagnosis, treatment, care models, and regulatory reform.

Held under one roof, this dual-conference format enables critical cross-sector collaboration and positions the Summit as a central meeting point for the full spectrum of leaders working with people with dementia. **Register for either conference and gain full access to the summit**

Why Attend?

Access both conferences for one price

With freedom to move between the two conferences throughout the day, you can pick the sessions and topics that are most relevant to you.

Send your full team

Bring along the full team from your organisation to the event, from directors, nurses and clinical staff can attend with discounts available for group bookings across the two events.

CPD approved

Both conferences are CPD approved for 7 points per day, meaning you can continue your learning while hearing from leading experts in the field.



WHY SPONSOR

Position your brand where it matters most—at the heart of Australia’s aged care transformation. This focused summit brings together 120+ senior leaders from over 50 aged care providers; people driving clinical governance, workforce capability, and person-centred innovation.

Whether your expertise lies in digital care tools, behaviour support, staff training, compliance, or assistive technologies, this event offers a high-value platform to engage decision-makers who are ready to act.

WHO SHOULD SPONSOR?

- **Allied Health Providers:** Engage providers seeking therapies and support tools tailored to dementia.
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- **Assistive Technology & Mobility Solutions:** Show how your innovations improve safety, independence, and wellbeing for those with cognitive decline.

Interested in sponsoring?
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👤 **Charlie Wright**
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TWO-DAY CONFERENCE	SAVE \$500 BOOK BEFORE 15 AUGUST	FULL PRICE
AGED CARE/DISABILITY CARE PROVIDER & NFP RATE	\$1,499	\$1,999
GOVERNMENT RATE	\$1,999	\$2,499
VENDOR PASS	\$3,499	\$3,999

CLICK HERE TO REGISTER ONLINE

SEND 3 DELEGATES, SAVE \$150 PER PERSON (TOTAL \$450 OFF)

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All prices are in AUD and exclude GST. Early Bird discounts are subject to availability. If you do not fall under the categories amassing Not-for-Profit & Disability Service Providers, the Government rate applies

VENDOR RATE: If your organisation provides a solution or service to the primary delegate market, the vendor rate applies.

CONTACT INFORMATION

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To find out how we can help you meet your marketing and business development goals, contact **Charlie Wright**, Sponsorship Manager, on **charlie.wright@aventedge.com**



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- All invoiced sums, including applicable taxes, are payable in full by the delegate to Avertedge.
- Payment is applicable when registration fees have been invoiced.
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- Should a delegate be unable to attend the event and wish to cancel their invoiced registration then this will be subject to the following:
 - All requests for cancellation need to be made in writing to the relevant Avertedge office
 - Cancellations 15 days or more before the event: a credit voucher valid for 12 months will be issued less a \$250 + GST administration fee will be charged per delegate
 - Within 14 days before the event: no credit notes permitted
 - Registrations can be transferred to a colleague from the same company before the event without incurring a fee
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